

Chapter 2

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Nutrition Power-Up Worksheet for Chapter 2

Hey High School Crew! Ready to level up your nutrition game? This worksheet is designed to make learning about food fun, interactive, and totally relatable. You'll dive into the key ideas from Chapter 2—understanding nutrients, building balanced plates, decoding labels, and eating healthy on a budget—while applying them to your own life. Grab a pen, a snack (bonus points if it's healthy!), and let's get started. Complete this worksheet solo or with a friend for extra laughs and ideas!

Part 1: Nutrient Detective – What Fuels You?

Goal: Identify the nutrients your body needs and match them to real-life foods you eat or want to try.

Instructions: Below are descriptions of the major nutrients from Section 1. Write down one food you've eaten recently (or plan to eat) that fits each category. Then, rate how often you eat this type of food (Daily, Weekly, Rarely). Be honest—no judgment here!

Nutrient	Role in Body	Your Food Example	How Often? (Daily/Weekly/Rarely)
Carbohydrates	Main energy source for your day		
Proteins	Builds and repairs muscles and tissues		
Healthy Fats	Protects brain, nerves; helps absorb vitamins		
Vitamins (e.g., C, D)	Supports immunity, bones, vision		
Minerals (e.g., Iron, Calcium)	Strengthens bones, carries oxygen in blood		

Nutrient

Role in Body

Your Food Example

How Often? (Daily/Weekly/Rarely)

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Builds and repairs muscles and tissues

Healthy Fats

Protects brain, nerves; helps absorb vitamins

Vitamins (e.g., C, D)

Supports immunity, bones, vision

Minerals (e.g., Iron, Calcium)

Strengthens bones, carries oxygen in blood

Reflection Question: Which nutrient do you think you need to eat more of, and why? (Example: “I rarely eat healthy fats, so I’ll try adding avocado to my toast.”)

Part 2: Build Your Ultimate Balanced Plate

Goal: Create a meal using all five food groups to fuel your busy teen life. **Instructions:** Imagine you’re planning a lunch or dinner. Using Section 2 as a guide, list one food from each food group to build a balanced plate. Then, sketch your plate in the circle below (doesn’t have to be art—just label the foods!). Use the recommended daily amounts as a rough guide (e.g., 2-3 cups veggies).

Food Group	Your Choice	Portion (Estimate Using Hand Guide)
Fruits (1.5-2 cups)		
Vegetables (2-3 cups)		
Grains (6-8 oz, half whole)		
Protein (5-6.5 oz)		
Dairy or Alternative (3 cups)		

Food Group

Your Choice

Portion (Estimate Using Hand Guide)

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Vegetables (2-3 cups)

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Protein (5-6.5 oz)

Dairy or Alternative (3 cups)

Sketch Your Plate Here: (Draw a circle and label each section with your foods)

Reflection Question: How does this meal compare to what you usually eat? Is there one food group you often skip, and how can you add it in?

Part 3: Label Sleuth – Crack the Code!

Goal: Practice reading food labels to make smarter choices. **Instructions:** Grab a packaged food item from home (like a snack bar, cereal, or canned soup) or use a label image online if you can't access one. Answer the questions below based on the Nutrition Facts and Ingredients List (refer to Section 3 for help).

Write the product name here: _____

Label Element	Your Finding
Serving Size	
Calories per Serving	
Added Sugar (grams)	
Sodium (mg)	
First 3 Ingredients	

Label Element

Your Finding

Serving Size

Calories per Serving

Added Sugar (grams)

Sodium (mg)

First 3 Ingredients

Reflection Question: Is this a smart choice for a regular snack or meal based on the label? Why or why not? (Example: “Too much sugar at 20g per serving—I’ll save it for a treat.”)

Bonus Challenge: Compare this item to a similar one (real or imagined) with better stats (less sugar, sodium, etc.). What would you pick instead?

Part 4: Budget Bites – Plan a Cheap & Healthy Meal

Goal: Design a nutritious meal on a tight budget using tips from Section 4. **Instructions:** Plan a simple meal (breakfast, lunch, or dinner) for yourself or your family with a budget of \$5 or less total. Use budget tips like buying bulk, frozen, or on-sale items. List your ingredients, estimated cost per item (guess if you don't know exact prices), and total cost. Aim for at least 3 food groups.

Ingredient	Food Group	Estimated Cost

Total Cost:		

Ingredient

Food Group

Estimated Cost

Total Cost:

Reflection Question: What budget tip did you use to keep costs low (e.g., frozen veggies, bulk grains)? How could you stretch this meal further (e.g., leftovers)?

Part 5: Personal Nutrition Challenge – Make It Yours!

Goal: Set a fun, achievable nutrition goal for the next week based on what you've learned. **Instructions:** Pick ONE small change from any section of Chapter 2 to try out. It could be drinking more water, adding a veggie to dinner, reading a label before buying a snack, or packing a budget-friendly lunch. Write your goal below, how you'll do it, and who (if anyone) you'll team up with for support.

- **My Nutrition Goal:** _____
- **How I'll Do It (Specific Plan):** _____
- **My Support Buddy (Friend/Family/None):** _____

Reflection Question: Why did you pick this goal? How do you think it'll make you feel after a week?

Bonus Fun Activity: Food Fuel Face-Off!

Goal: Make nutrition social and creative! **Instructions:** Challenge a friend, sibling, or classmate to a "Healthy Snack Showdown." Each of you creates a snack under \$2 that includes at least 2 food groups. Snap a pic or describe it, then "vote" on which looks tastiest or most creative. Write your snack idea here:

- **My Snack:** _____
- **Food Groups Included:** _____
- **Estimated Cost:** _____
- **Who Won the Showdown & Why?** _____